

Diet Planner App

Ekrem Karakas, Member 2, Member 3, Member 4

1. Motivation & Problem Statement

Describe the real-world problem your project addresses and explain why it matters. Identify the specific gap, limitation, or opportunity that motivates this work. State the core research question or engineering goal in one clear sentence. Cite relevant prior work or context that frames the problem (1–2 references are sufficient). Aim for roughly 8–12 sentences.

TODO - GOT FROM PROPOSAL MIGHT NEED UPDATING

Balancing all the various micro and macronutrients can be a challenge, with different foods all having different amounts of each. Because there aren't good ways to ingest just one type of nutrient, it can be difficult to balance your diet such that every daily recommendation is met without going over or under. Many meal-planning tools generate a static daily or weekly plan that assumes the user will follow it exactly. In practice, people often deviate from their plans by eating unplanned meals or snacks, which can lead to nutritional imbalance. Existing tools like MacroFactor can help by generating “a dynamic nutrition plan that adjusts your diet to fit your metabolism”, but following a strict plan may not be the best option if some nutrients are unplanned, but consumed anyway. A lot of these apps also rely heavily on tracking rather than making recommendations, such as MacroFactor advertising that the app can be used to “track vitamins and minerals, set custom targets, and dive into rich analytics”. While providing this information can be useful, applying machine learning on top of this can generate optimal nutritional feedback dynamically. Hungryroot is another existing tool, a personalized grocery delivery and meal recommendation service designed to simplify healthy eating. When users sign up, they take a quiz about their dietary preferences, nutritional goals, and food dislikes. Based on these inputs, Hungryroot curates a weekly selection of grocery items and simple recipes tailored to the user's profile. The platform blends grocery delivery with meal suggestions

2. Approach

Summarize your technical approach at a high level. Describe the system architecture or methodology, key algorithms or models used, and the most important design decisions. If applicable, include a small figure or diagram (use \includegraphics), and resize to stay within bounded box area. Mention the primary tools, frameworks, or libraries (e.g., PyTorch, Mesa, Gymnasium, PettingZoo). Clearly state any assumptions or scope limitations. Aim for roughly 10–15 sentences or equivalent with an optional figure.

Preprocessing

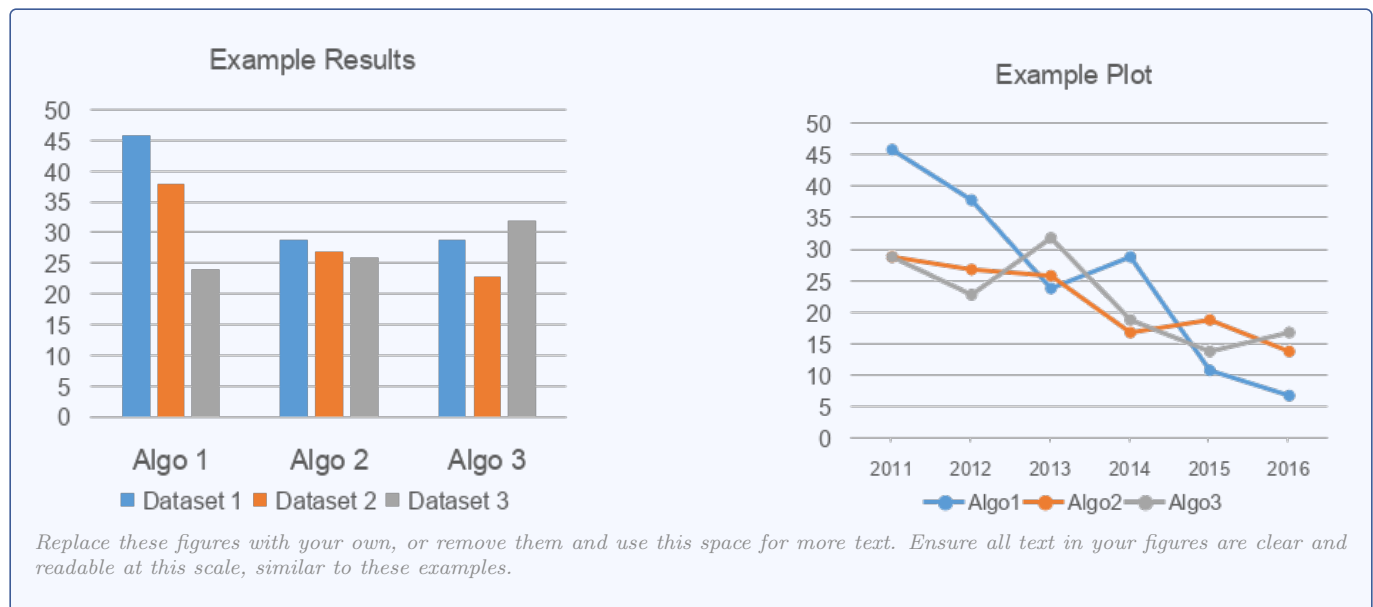
We are pulling data from two sources (USDA Foundation Foods and Open Food Facts). The data is normalized to a per 100g basis, cleaned by dropping incomplete or unrealistic rows, and filtered down to 10,000 foods.

Simulated Annealing

The implementation represents a meal as a tuple of (food_index, multiplier). The meal plan is a list of meals, one per meal slot. The state is initialized using the greedy-init algorithm. At each step, one of three neighbor moves is applied. Replace swaps a slot's food for any food from the dataset. Swap exchanges two foods between their slots. Resize updates a meal's multiplier by a random delta taken from a uniform distribution between -0.5 and 0.5. Each candidate is evaluated using the energy function (1 - fitness function). Better neighboring states are always accepted while worse plans are accepted probabilistically based on the current temperature that decays geometrically by time.

3. Key Results

Present the most important quantitative and/or qualitative results. Include 1–2 key metrics, comparisons, or summary statistics. Interpret the results: what worked well, what was surprising, and how do the outcomes compare with your initial expectations or baselines? Aim for roughly 8–12 sentences or equivalent. Small tables, figures, or charts may be embedded here, and/or in the first box on the next page (examples on next page).



4. Challenges & Lessons Learned

Discuss the main technical and organizational challenges encountered during the project. For each challenge, briefly explain how the team addressed or mitigated it. Highlight lessons learned that would be valuable for future work or for other teams tackling similar problems. Aim for roughly 8–12 sentences.

5. Individual Contributions

Replace the table below with your team's actual contributions.

Member	Primary Contributions	Approx. %
Ekrem Karakas	Preprocessing Data, Simulated Annealing, Energy Function	20%
Member 2	e.g., Data pipeline, evaluation scripts	20%
Member 3	e.g., Environment design and implementation	20%
Member 4	e.g., Data pipeline, evaluation scripts	20%
Member 5	e.g., System design, agent logic	20%

6. Repository & References

GitHub Repository: <https://github.com/4oore/CS4100-Group-Project>

Ensure repo is public, or add instructor as a collaborator.

Project Tracker: <https://github.com/users/4oore/projects/1>

Key References:

- [1] Author(s), "Title," Venue, Year. Brief annotation.
- [2] Author(s), "Title," Venue, Year. Brief annotation.
- [3] Author(s), "Title," Venue, Year. Brief annotation.

Add or remove reference entries as needed (3–4 recommended).